Our Gifts Represent the (Portrayed) Character of God

■ Romans 12:6; 1 Corinthians 12:4–6

Beloved in Christ, let's take a moment to reflect on how our gifts are not merely abilities but divine expressions of God's very nature. The following message is a teaching reminder on how the gifts we have—both by grace and by the Spirit—are channels through which God reveals Himself in and through us. May this word strengthen your walk and stir gratitude in your service to the Lord.

In *1 Corinthians 12:6*, the Bible tells us that "it is the same God who works in all of us." This means that when God works in and through us, it is often reflected in the way we express our gifts. If you want to know how God is working in you, examine how you are exercising your gifting.

The more you grow in your gifts, the more God works in you—and vice versa. But what, then, is the character of God? The **character of God** describes His divine nature—who He is at the very core.

What Are the Gifts Being Talked About?

In *1 Corinthians 12:7–10*, we are taught about the **gifts of the Spirit**, which include: the message of wisdom, the message of knowledge, prophecy, healing, discernment of spirits, speaking in tongues, and interpretation of tongues.

In *Romans 12:6–8*, Paul speaks about **grace gifts**—various abilities given to each of us through the grace of God. These include prophecy, serving, teaching, encouragement, giving, leadership, and showing mercy.

It's important not to confuse grace gifts with spiritual gifts (or gifts of the Spirit). We are **born with grace gifts** (*Romans 12:6–8*), but **gifts of the Spirit** are given by the **Holy Spirit** after we come to Christ. Through Christ in us, we are empowered to live out God's identity.

The fact that I can express these gifts or live a certain life does not mean I am powerful or learned—it is purely by grace, through which God enables me to carry out His identity

here on earth. I cannot do this on my own, but only through He who works in me (*1 Corinthians 12:6; Philippians 2:13*).

Our gifting represents God's image and character. The gifts we show portray God's character through us. This truth should fill us with deep gratitude—knowing that we are agents chosen to reflect the Almighty God's likeness by grace.

Final Exhortation

Never downplay any gift, and never operate in your gifts outside of God's plan or His Word. Any action, work, or character not influenced by God does not carry His identity.
Ask yourself—whose identity does it then carry?

■ Part 2 coming soon…

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